

# AD NAUSEAM

## Art & Audio Asset Manifest

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A production checklist of every character, item, screen, and sound the game needs — a 2D satirical survivor-action game where enemies are the machinery of the ad-funded web, the player is **The User**, and XP is **Engagement**.

*Derived from the data-driven content in src/content/ and the placeholder primitives in src/core/textures.ts. Everything below currently renders as a tinted white shape, so this is the full from-scratch brief, not a gap analysis.*

## Art direction north star

The fiction is the mechanic. Enemies are the machinery of the ad-funded web; the player is “The User”; XP is “Engagement.” A flat, satirical UI-chrome look (browser buttons, banners, modal dialogs, cursors) reads truer than fantasy-monster art. Everything is tinted by a single color field, so each asset should read clearly as a white/greyscale silhouette that takes a tint cleanly.

## 1 Characters

### 1.1 Player

| Character | Fiction                                   | Placeholder                        | Art needed                                                     |
|-----------|-------------------------------------------|------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|
| The User  | You, fighting back against the modern web | Blue circle (#40ccff) + facing pip | Player sprite (idle + facing set), hit/hurt flash, death frame |

**States:** idle, moving, taking damage (hit-flash), invulnerable (i-frame shimmer), silenced/locked-out (Paywall — weapons greyed), death. Movement is a unified vector, so art needs a clear facing indicator.

### 1.2 Enemies — the roster (six archetypes, four behaviour arms)

| ID             | Display name        | Role         | Behaviour       | Tint    | Art needed                                                |
|----------------|---------------------|--------------|-----------------|---------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| popup_grunt    | Popup Grunt         | Basic melee  | chase           | #f2bf33 | Pop-up window w/ close x, hit-flash, death poof           |
| tracking_pixel | Tracking Pixel      | Basic ranged | ranged_standoff | #ff5f9e | Crosshair / pixel / eye, muzzle flare, bolt projectile    |
| cookie_banner  | Cookie Banner       | Adv. melee   | chase_aura      | #a9743d | “We value your privacy” banner + slow-field aura          |
| autoplay_ogre  | Autoplay Video Ogre | Mini-boss    | telegraph_aoe   | #9933b3 | Big video player (■ face), wind-up, telegraph ring, blast |
| paywall        | Paywall             | Adv. ranged  | ranged_standoff | #d94f4f | “Subscribe to continue” wall, wind-up, lockout shot       |
| the_algorithm  | The Algorithm       | Final boss   | ranged_standoff | #e6e6f0 | Abstract feed/algorithm boss, telegraph, bolt volley      |

**Per-archetype states:** spawn/arrive, idle/move, telegraph/wind-up (ranged + AoE only), attack/fire, hit-flash (a tint lerp — no redraw), death.

## 2 Items, Weapons & Projectiles

### 2.1 Weapons (player)

| ID            | Display name           | Kind                 | Art needed                                               |
|---------------|------------------------|----------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|
| adblock_sword | AdBlock+ Sword         | Melee cleave (wedge) | Sword sprite + swing arc VFX, 5 arc widths (100° → 200°) |
| dnt_boomerang | Do Not Track Boomerang | Ranged, returning    | Boomerang/“DNT” disc, spin anim, return trail, multi-fan |

## 2.2 Projectiles & attack VFX

| Element          | Source                        | Art needed                                   |
|------------------|-------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|
| Sword cleave arc | AdBlock+ Sword                | Sweep/slash VFX, 5 widths (100°, +25° ×4)    |
| Boomerang shot   | DNT Boomerang                 | Disc + spin + out/return trail; fan up to +3 |
| Enemy bolt       | Tracking Pixel, The Algorithm | Small aimed projectile + impact              |
| Lockout shot     | Paywall                       | Slow fat shot + “weapons disabled” burst     |
| AoE blast        | Autoplay Video Ogre           | Pulsing telegraph ring + ground-slam impact  |
| Slow-field aura  | Cookie Banner                 | Persistent ground decal (radius 150)         |

## 2.3 Pickups & world items

| Item                  | Fiction                               | Art needed                                                           |
|-----------------------|---------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Engagement</b>     | XP dropped on death, drifts to player | Gem/orb, tiered small→large (value 1→100), magnet trail, collect pop |
| <b>Damage numbers</b> | Deterministic hit feedback            | Typography pass (sword 140–500, boomerang 100–400)                   |

# 3 Environment & Arena

| Element                  | Notes                               | Art needed                                                 |
|--------------------------|-------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|
| Arena floor / background | 2D survivor arena, landscape-locked | Tiling ground (“the web” — page/feed motif), edge vignette |
| Arena bounds             | Play-space limits                   | Boundary treatment (browser-chrome frame? off-page fade?)  |
| Ambient dressing         | Optional                            | Scrolling feed, parallax banners, drifting UI detritus     |

# 4 UI, HUD & Screens

## 4.1 HUD (always-on parallel scene)

- **Health bar** — The User HP (max 1000); bar frame + fill
- **Engagement / XP bar** — progress to next level
- **Level indicator**, **run timer** (toward 30:00), **kill counter**
- **Phase readout** (optional) — Quick Start → God-Tier Survival
- **Silence/lockout indicator** — when Paywall disables weapons
- **Virtual joystick** — canvas thumbstick base + nub skin

## 4.2 Modal & full-screen states (DOM overlay)

| Screen                | Trigger                  | Art needed                                                         |
|-----------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Level-Up Modal</b> | On level-up, pick 1 of 3 | Card frames, upgrade icons (\$5), selection states, pause backdrop |

| Screen                      | Trigger                   | Art needed                                                       |
|-----------------------------|---------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Ad-Break / Game Over</b> | On death                  | "GAME OVER" treatment, fake ad frame, 5s countdown, flavour text |
| <b>Win Screen</b>           | Clock ends / boss killed  | "YOU SURVIVED" treatment, run-stats readout, Play Again button   |
| <b>Title / boot</b>         | App launch                | Logo, "AD NAUSEAM" wordmark, start button                        |
| <b>Phase transition</b>     | Phase boundary (optional) | Phase-name banner ×7 (Quick Start ... God-Tier Survival)         |

### 4.3 App / platform assets

- App icon (iOS + Android via Capacitor), splash screen, store screenshots
- Favicon for the web build
- Desktop cursor (could be themed as an ad-blocker cursor)

## 5 Upgrade Icons (level-up cards)

One icon per upgrade record in `src/content/upgrades.ts`:

| Upgrade ID           | Title                  | Icon concept                        |
|----------------------|------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| sword_damage         | <b>Premium Blade</b>   | +damage sword                       |
| sword_arc            | <b>Wider Cleave</b>    | Widening arc                        |
| grant_boomerang      | <b>Do Not Track</b>    | Boomerang unlock (guaranteed offer) |
| boomerang_damage     | <b>Sharper Signal</b>  | Sharpened disc                      |
| boomerang_projectile | <b>Multi-Track</b>     | Fanned discs                        |
| move_speed           | <b>Bandwidth Boost</b> | Speed / bandwidth                   |
| cooldown             | <b>Battery Saver</b>   | Battery / faster-fire               |

## 6 Sound Effects (SFX)

### 6.1 Player

- Move/footstep loop (subtle, or omit for arcade feel)
- Take damage / hurt
- Low-health warning loop
- Death sting
- Invulnerable shimmer (optional)
- Weapons-silenced (Paywall) engage + expire

### 6.2 Weapons

- AdBlock+ Sword swing (whoosh) + hit/impact
- DNT Boomerang throw + spin loop + return catch + hit
- Multi-track fan (layered variant)

### 6.3 Enemies (per archetype: spawn / attack / hit / death)

- Popup Grunt — pop-up blip spawn, nagging chase, satisfying “close” pop on death
- Tracking Pixel — telegraph blip, bolt fire, whiz-by, death
- Cookie Banner — deploy/unfurl, aura hum loop (slow field), death
- Autoplay Video Ogre — unmute/autoplay sting, AoE wind-up, ground slam, death
- Paywall — long wind-up, “subscribe” lockout shot + impact, death
- The Algorithm — boss arrival stinger, bolt volley, hit, defeat sequence

### 6.4 Pickups & progression

- Engagement pickup (pitch rises with tier / combo escalation)
- Engagement magnet/drift shimmer
- Level-up chime (pauses run)
- Upgrade card hover + select/confirm

### 6.5 UI / meta

- Menu navigate / confirm / back
- Modal open / close
- Ad-break countdown ticks + “you may skip” (satirical) + resume
- Win jingle / lose sting
- Damage-number tick (very light / muted at volume)

### 6.6 Ambient / phase

- Phase-transition sweep (7 phases ramping intensity)
- Arena ambience / drone bed

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## 7 Music & Audio Design

- **Menu / title theme** — sets the satirical tone
- **Gameplay music** — intensity-layered stems across the 7 phases (Quick Start calm → God-Tier Survival frantic); layers add as pressure ramps
- **Boss music** — The Algorithm (final phase)
- **Ad-break jingle** — deliberately obnoxious, for the death screen (the joke)
- **Win theme / stinger**

**Mix & tech:** duck so the level-up chime and hit feedback cut through swarm noise; voice/instance-limit the uncapped Popup Grunt swarm (pool + cap concurrent pop sounds); consistent bus routing (SFX/Music/UI) for master volume + mute; short, punchy, high-legibility SFX since dozens of hits land per second.

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## 8 Priority Notes for Production

- **Tint-friendly silhouettes.** Every entity is drawn white and tinted by one color value, including the hit-flash (a tint lerp, not a redraw). Author art as clean white/greyscale so a single tint reads correctly.
- **Telegraphs are gameplay, not decoration.** The Pixel (0.45s), Ogre (1.1s), Paywall (0.9s), and Algorithm (0.6s) all wind up before firing — the telegraph VFX + audio cue are what make each attack fair. Prioritise these.

- **Swarm legibility.** The Popup Grunt is uncapped and is the whole arena's "texture." Its art and sound must survive dozens on screen at once.
- **Damage numbers stay a fixed set.** Damage is deterministic, so a baked-texture typography pass is enough — no dynamic text system required.